

Superstore Sales & Profitability Analysis

Management-focused report based on the Excel Orders dataset, Pivot Tables, and Dashboard. This version intentionally contains no charts and follows the structure and level of detail of the supplied reference report.

1. Executive Summary

This project analyses sales performance, customer/transaction activity, product profitability, and regional performance using Microsoft Excel. The analysis covers January 2014 to December 2017 and combines the raw Orders dataset with Pivot Table analysis and a dashboard to provide a consolidated view of business performance.

The analysis recorded total sales of **\$2,292,669.37**, total profit of **\$286,397.02**, **9,994** transaction records, **5,009** distinct orders, and **37,873** units sold. Overall profit margin was **12.5%**.

Performance strengthened over the period. Annual sales increased from \$479,716.01 in 2014 to \$733,215.26 in 2017, while annual profit increased from \$49,543.97 to \$93,439.27.

2. Business Objective

The purpose of the analysis was to transform the underlying transaction data into a management-friendly dashboard and analytical report that could be used to monitor:

- Overall sales and profit performance
- Performance trends across the analysis period
- Customer segment contribution
- Regional sales and profitability
- Product category and sub-category performance
- Quantity and transaction activity
- Discount levels and potential margin risks

The dashboard and Pivot Tables were designed to make key performance patterns easier to identify without requiring users to manually analyse the underlying dataset.

3. Data & Methodology

The dataset contains **9,994** transaction records and 21 fields, including order dates, customer information, geographic information, product classifications, sales, quantity, discount, and profit. The analysis covers four calendar years: 2014 through 2017.

The analysis included:

- Data organization and validation
- Pivot Table aggregation
- Annual performance analysis
- Regional sales and profit analysis
- Customer segment analysis
- Category and sub-category profitability analysis
- KPI analysis
- Dashboard development
- Business insight and recommendation development

Excel Pivot Tables were used to summarize the underlying transaction data before interpreting the dashboard and producing this report.

4. Key Performance Results

Metric	Result
Total Sales	\$2,292,669.37

Total Profit	\$286,397.02
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Metric	Result
Transaction Records	9,994
Distinct Orders	5,009
Quantity Sold	37,873
Profit Margin	12.5%
Average Sales per Transaction	\$229.40
Average Discount	15.6%

5. Key Findings

Sales Performance

Total recorded sales were \$2,292,669.37. Sales increased from \$479,716.01 in 2014 to \$733,215.26 in 2017. The 2017 result represents the strongest annual sales performance in the dataset. Although sales declined slightly from 2014 to 2015, performance recovered strongly in 2016 and continued upward in 2017.

Profit Performance

Total recorded profit was \$286,397.02, producing an overall margin of 12.5%. Profit increased each year after 2014, reaching \$93,439.27 in 2017. This indicates that the business was not only generating greater sales volume over time but also increasing absolute profit.

Customer Segment Performance

Segment	Sales	Profit	Margin
Consumer	\$1,159,839.45	\$134,119.21	11.6%
Corporate	\$703,176.77	\$91,979.13	13.1%
Home Office	\$429,653.15	\$60,298.68	14.0%

Consumer is the largest segment by sales, contributing \$1,159,839.45, while Home Office records the highest segment margin at 14.0%. This shows that sales volume and profitability are not distributed in exactly the same way across customer segments.

Regional Profitability

Region	Sales	Profit	Margin
West	\$724,403.14	\$108,418.45	15.0%
East	\$676,329.92	\$91,522.78	13.5%
South	\$390,696.42	\$46,749.43	12.0%
Central	\$501,239.89	\$39,706.36	7.9%

West recorded the highest regional profit at \$108,418.45, followed by East at \$91,522.78. Central recorded the lowest profit at \$39,706.36 and the lowest regional margin at 7.9%. Central also has the highest average discount at 24.0%, making discount and pricing practices an important area for further review.

6. Product Performance

Category Performance

Category	Sales	Profit	Margin
Technology	\$836,154.03	\$145,454.95	17.4%
Furniture	\$738,004.71	\$18,451.27	2.5%
Office Supplies	\$718,510.62	\$122,490.80	17.0%

Technology is the strongest category by profit, generating \$145,454.95 at a 17.4% margin. Office Supplies also performs strongly with a 17.0% margin. Furniture is the main profitability concern: despite generating \$738,004.71 in sales, it produces only \$18,451.27 in profit, resulting in a margin of 2.5%.

Loss-Making Sub-Categories

Sub-Category	Sales	Profit	Margin	Avg. Discount
Tables	\$204,514.21	\$-17,725.48	- 8.7%	26.1%
Bookcases	\$114,880.00	\$-3,472.56	- 3.0%	21.1%
Supplies	\$46,673.54	\$-1,189.10	- 2.5%	7.7%

Tables represent the largest loss-making sub-category, with a loss of \$17,725.48. Bookcases and Supplies also generate negative profit. These areas should be investigated at a more detailed product/SKU level to determine whether pricing, discounting, product costs, or assortment decisions are driving the losses.

7. Business Insights

The analysis highlights five major business trends:

1. **Business performance strengthened over time.** Both sales and profit reached their highest annual levels in 2017.
2. **Profitability is concentrated in strong product categories.** Technology and Office Supplies contribute the majority of total profit.
3. **Furniture requires profitability improvement.** Its sales contribution is high relative to its profit contribution.
4. **Regional performance varies materially.** West leads profitability, while Central has the weakest margin.
5. **Discount management is a potential improvement area.** Central's high discount level occurs alongside its weak margin, supporting further investigation.

8. Recommendations

1. **Review loss-making products.** Conduct SKU-level analysis of Tables, Bookcases, and Supplies to identify pricing, cost, discount, and assortment issues.
2. **Strengthen discount controls.** Establish clearer discount thresholds, particularly for low-margin categories and regions.
3. **Protect profitable growth.** Continue supporting Technology and other high-margin product groups while monitoring whether additional sales growth maintains acceptable margins.
4. **Develop a Central-region improvement plan.** Investigate pricing, discounting, product mix, and operating factors contributing to the region's lower profitability.
5. **Monitor performance regularly.** Use the dashboard and Pivot Tables to track Sales, Profit, Margin, Discount, and loss-making products on a recurring basis.

9. Tools & Skills

Tools

- Microsoft Excel
- Pivot Tables
- Excel Dashboard

Skills

- Data preparation and validation
- Data analysis
- KPI analysis
- Trend analysis
- Sales analysis
- Customer segment analysis
- Regional profitability analysis
- Product profitability analysis
- Dashboard development
- Business reporting
- Data-driven recommendations

10. Conclusion

The analysis demonstrates how Microsoft Excel can be used to transform structured transaction data into management-focused business intelligence. The dataset generated \$2,292,669.37 in sales and \$286,397.02 in profit, with performance strengthening significantly by 2017. The analysis also identifies clear opportunities for improving profitability through stronger discount management, closer review of loss-making products, and targeted regional performance management.

The resulting Pivot Tables, dashboard, and analytical report provide a consolidated view of business performance while highlighting areas that can support further investigation and decision-making..